



In India, the distinction between flagship phones and high-end smartphones under ₹50,000 is becoming increasingly nuanced. In 2024, the market for high-end smartphones has seen substantial growth, driven by brands like OnePlus, iQOO, and Vivo offering powerful devices. These phones often forego niche flagship perks, such as advanced zoom lenses and wireless charging, while delivering exceptional performance for most users. This burgeoning segment now appeals to aspirational buyers, reflecting a shift in consumer priorities towards value-driven innovation, making premium technology accessible to a wider audience. Let's see which high-end phone lifts the Digit Zero1 trophy this year.

Winner: Vivo V40 Pro

The Vivo V40 Pro has emerged as the best high-end phone under ₹50,000 in India, despite stiff competition from its sister brand's iQOO Neo9 Pro. Both phones share a common focus on delivering flagship-level features at a lower price, but the V40 Pro edges out with its well-rounded capabilities. What truly sets it apart, though, are the Zeiss-tuned cameras, particularly the 50 MP Sony IMX816 telephoto portrait lens, which captures portraits that rival those of even pricier flagships. Whether it's stunning bokeh or crisp details, the V40 Pro excels in photography like no other phone in this segment. While the iQOO Neo9 Pro caters to users seeking raw gaming performance, the V40 Pro delivers a holistic experience. Its display quality, camera capabilities, and blazing-

High-End Phone

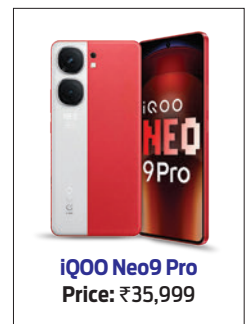
Flagship experience without burning a hole in your wallet



fast storage speeds surpass even the Neo9 Pro, ensuring smooth multitasking and rapid data transfers. The Vivo V40 Pro isn't just about speed – it's about performance across the board, making it the top choice for users who want premium features without splurging on a flagship device.

Runner-Up: iQOO Neo9 Pro

The iQOO Neo9 Pro stands tall as the ultimate choice for raw performance in the sub-₹50,000 segment. With an AnTuTu score exceeding 1.6 million, it leads the pack in CPU and GPU benchmarks, delivering flagship-level performance at a fraction of the cost. Its gaming capabilities are a standout feature, with titles like Genshin Impact running smoothly even at the highest graphics settings, offering a seamless and immersive experience. Thanks to excellent thermal management and software optimisation, the Neo9 Pro ensures sustained performance without compromising on battery life – an area where many high-performance devices fall short. Under the hood, its powerful hardware is complemented by thoughtful optimisations. While its sibling, the Vivo V40 Pro, offers a more rounded experience, the Neo9 Pro is the go-to device for gamers and enthusiasts who want flagship power in an affordable package.



Best Buy: OnePlus 12R

The OnePlus 12R is 2024's best value-for-money high-end phone, offering a stellar mix of performance, features, and endurance. Powered by the flagship Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 processor, it delivers exceptional speed and efficiency. Its tested display brightness of 1798 nits ensures fantastic visibility even under direct sunlight, while its read and write speeds rival the winner of this segment. The cameras, particularly the primary lens, are reliable for most scenarios. Additionally, its battery life and charging speeds set a benchmark, with most users easily getting two days of use on a single charge. For ₹39,999, it's an unbeatable all-rounder, which is why it nabs the Digit Best Buy Award.

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